at morning assembly. “Whomsoever I cane becomes a great man! Take my word, this boy is going to bring glory to his school and to his teachers.” His praise quite made up for the earlier humiliation!

By the time I completed my education at Schwartz, I was a selfconfident boy determined to succeed. The decision to go in for further education was taken without a second thought. To us, in those days, the awareness of the possibilities for a professional education did not exist; higher education simply meant going to col ege. The nearest col ege was at Tiruchchirappal i, spel ed Trichinopoly those days, and cal ed Trichi for short.

In 1950, I arrived at St. Joseph’s Col ege, Trichi, to study for the Intermediate examination. I was not a bright student in terms of examination grades but, thanks to my two buddies back in Rameswaram, I had acquired a practical bent of mind.